Figurative Language (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Example: Identify the figurative device: 'The stars winked playfully in the night sky.'

Answer: Personification — the stars are given the human action of 'winking playfully'.

Core Practice (15 questions)

1. Identify the figurative device: "The snow fell like feathers from the sky."
2. Identify the figurative device: "Pots and pans clattered and clanged in the kitchen."
3. Identify the figurative device: "Slippery snakes slithered silently through the sand."
4. Identify the figurative device: "The sun smiled down on the picnic."
5. Which type of figurative language is used in "Her voice was music to his ears"? A) simile B) metaphor C) alliteration D) onomatopoeia E) idiom
6. Which type of figurative language is used in "He ran as fast as a cheetah"? A) metaphor B) simile C) personification D) idiom E) alliteration
7. What does the idiom "a piece of cake" mean? A) Something delicious B) Something very easy to do C) A small portion D) A type of dessert E) Something expensive
8. Identify the figurative device: "The autumn leaves whispered as they fell."
9. Which word in this sentence is an example of onomatopoeia: "The fireworks went bang and the crowd cheered"?
10. Select ALL the sentences below that contain a metaphor. A) "He is a shining star on the team." B) "She ran like lightning." C) "The classroom was a zoo during the party." D) "The wind howled loudly." E) "Time is a thief, stealing moments away."
11. Identify the figurative device: "Big brown bears bathed by the brook."
12. What does the idiom "under the weather" mean?
13. Identify the figurative device: "Her heart was a block of ice."
14. Which type of figurative language is used in "The kettle hissed and the bacon crackled"? A) simile B) onomatopoeia C) metaphor D) idiom E) alliteration
15. Identify the figurative device: "The old car grumbled and groaned as it started."

Applied Practice (15 questions)

1. Explain the meaning created by the simile: "The playground was as chaotic as a zoo at feeding time."
2. Explain the meaning created by the metaphor: "Her determination was a fire that never went out."
3. Identify the TWO figurative devices used in: "The waves roared like thunder against the cliffs," and explain each briefly.
4. What does the idiom "to have your head in the clouds" mean?
5. Which type of figurative language is used in "The crisp, crunching leaves crackled underfoot"? A) simile B) metaphor C) onomatopoeia D) idiom E) personification

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6. Choose the best interpretation of the idiom "the last straw" in: "Losing his keys after a terrible day was the last straw — he finally lost his temper." A) A piece of hay B) The final small event that causes someone to lose patience after a series of problems C) A type of drinking straw D) The best part of the day E) A lucky break

7. Identify the figurative device: "The icy wind bit at their faces."

8. Write a simile of your own to describe a very hot day.

9. Write a metaphor of your own to describe someone who is extremely tired.

10. Select ALL the sentences below that contain personification. A) "The fog crept silently over the hills." B) "He is as quiet as a mouse." C) "The machine groaned under the strain." D) "Success is a ladder we must climb." E) "The curtains danced in the gentle breeze."

11. What does the idiom "to cost an arm and a leg" mean?

12. Explain why "The classroom was a beehive of activity" is a metaphor rather than a simile.

13. Identify the figurative device: "Tick-tock went the clock as the exam minutes slipped away."

14. Which idiom best completes: "I thought the test would be easy, but it turned out to be a ___." A) walk in the park B) piece of the puzzle C) drop in the ocean D) different kettle of fish E) storm in a teacup

15. Choose the best interpretation of "Her words cut him to the bone." A) Her words were about bones B) Her words physically injured him C) Her words deeply hurt his feelings D) Her words were whispered quietly E) Her words were about medicine

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. Identify the figurative device in this sentence, given that it ALSO contains alliteration: "The brave little boat battled bravely against the roaring waves."

2. What does the idiom "to add insult to injury" mean, and why is it also a kind of exaggeration (hyperbole) of the literal idea of injury?

3. Identify the figurative device in: "The fire's fingers crept up the curtains," giving the single best overall label for a phrase that gives human body parts AND a human action to a non-human thing.

4. A simile says one thing but a metaphor states the same comparison more directly. Rewrite the simile "The children were as loud as a thunderstorm" as a metaphor.

5. The idiom "kill two birds with one stone" is often misunderstood literally. Explain its real meaning, then explain why someone unfamiliar with idioms might misinterpret the sentence "Let's kill two birds with one stone and visit Grandma on the way to the shop."

6. Read: "The old house sighed as the wind pushed through its broken windows, and its shutters clattered like chattering teeth." Identify all THREE figurative devices present and explain each.

7. Select ALL the idioms below that mean 'to be extremely busy'. A) up to your eyes B) have your hands full C) twiddle your thumbs D) run off your feet E) at a loose end

8. Explain, using an example, how onomatopoeia and alliteration can both appear in the same sentence without being the same device.

9. Which sentence best demonstrates personification rather than a simile, even though both describe the moon? A) "The moon glowed like a silver coin." B) "The moon watched over the sleeping village." C) "The moon was as bright as a torch." D) "The moon shone brightly in the clear sky." E) "The moon looked like a pale balloon."

10. Write a short extended metaphor (2 sentences) comparing someone's mind to a busy, cluttered room.

11. Which statement best explains why "The rain hammered down" is more vivid than "The rain fell"? A) It uses alliteration to add rhythm B) It personifies the rain, giving it a violent, forceful human-like action that intensifies

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the image C) It is a simile comparing rain to a hammer D) It uses onomatopoeia only E) It is a literal, factual description

12. Select ALL the sentences below that contain an idiom used correctly in context. A) "After the long journey, we were all dead on our feet." B) "He broke the ice by paying for the whole meal." C) "She felt like a fish out of water at the fancy dinner, since she didn't know anyone." D) "It's a piece of cake to lift that heavy box." E) "They decided to bite the bullet and finally tell their parents the truth."

13. Explain why writers sometimes mix a simile and personification in the SAME sentence (e.g. "The trees reached out like beckoning arms"), rather than using just one device.

14. Which idiom means almost the OPPOSITE of "the last straw" in terms of how much patience someone has left? A) at the end of your tether B) cool as a cucumber C) a drop in the ocean D) the straw that broke the camel's back E) at your wit's end

15. Read the short passage: "The exam hall was silent except for the frantic scratching of pencils. Tom's mind raced like a hamster on a wheel, going nowhere fast." Identify the simile AND explain what it reveals about Tom's state of mind.

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